

LOOK OUT FOR...



B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

PRANAV VENKATESH

Pranav Venkatesh, the 75th Grandmaster from India and 27th from Tamil Nadu, is another prodigious talent emerging from Chennai. Born on October 13 2006, the 18-year-old has already built an impressive resume in chess.

In 2024, Pranav clinched gold at the FIDE World Youth Under-18 Open Rapid, finishing with 9.5/11, and dominated the Blitz event with 19.5/22, four points ahead of his nearest rival.

Earlier, he showcased his skills at the World U-16 Youth Olympiad 2022, remaining undefeated with a score of 8.0/9 to win individual gold on Board 1, helping Team India finish fifth. In the same year, he also won the Challengers Chess Tour by defeating Raunak Sadhwani in the final.

Pranav triumphed in the Challenger section of the Chennai Grand Masters in November 2024, guaranteeing himself a spot at the Masters event of this tournament in 2025. At the 2024 World Rapid and Blitz Championships in New York, Pranav delivered a creditable performance, finishing 44th in the Rapid section (7.5/13) and 29th in the Blitz section (7.0/13) in highly competitive fields.

Currently, with a live Elo rating of 2615.0, Pranav ranks 135th globally and 10th in the junior rankings. His peak rating is 2632, which he achieved in June 2024.